



The Age of Gen Z

The Cockroach Janata Party is, by all accounts, the newest political start-up in town. What began as a reaction to a courtroom observation quickly acquired a life of its own. An upset Gen Z has electrified the country's politics and forced attention on India's examination system with an agitation that took the Centre by surprise. The education minister has stepped down, and the larger hope is that the Nandan Nilekani committee set up by Prime Minister Narendra Modi will design a robust system for foolproof examinations.

Against this backdrop comes our latest issue on the new start-up billionaires, many of whom founded their companies when they were in the Gen Z age cohort. It is about people who have built companies from scratch and created large businesses in a relatively short period of time.

The lead essay looks at India's new generation of billionaires. As the data shows, the time taken to move from an idea to a billion-dollar fortune has collapsed over the past couple of decades. Technology, cheap bandwidth, digital payments, lower entry barriers, and the rise of consumer businesses have created a much longer runway for ambitious founders to take off. The median age of this new crop is just 33, compared with 67 for India's billionaire population overall. The late Dhirubhai Ambani was nearly 60 when he became India's first self-made dollar billionaire in 1991-92. Azim Premji entered the club eight years later, in his mid-50s, when Wipro's valuation surged during the dot-com boom.

Elsewhere in the issue, we turn to the second coming of founders who had already built and exited businesses. These serial entrepreneurs have made a comeback—returning with deeper pockets, more experience, stronger networks, and sharper

business instincts. Investors are backing them readily because these entrepreneurs bring a proven record to the cap table.

Then come the rocket men. India's space sector, under state-control until six years ago, is now witnessing the growth of entrepreneur-led private-sector firms. We profile four space-tech start-ups building rockets and propulsion systems, and launch technologies as they seek a place in the stars.

Together, these stories capture an India where founders are starting up with conviction and with the ambition to build fast. This new generation of Indian founders is pushing ahead, innovating, and building for the future.

Earlier this year, our first-of-its-kind survey showed how Gen Z is redefining consumption, forcing Indian companies to rethink their products and pricing. That cover image, shown here, now seems less a look back and more an early warning: a generation that can reshape business through its consumption choices will demand the same responsiveness from Indian politics.

Underestimate Gen Z, and it will build the next start-up—be it commercial or political.

Siddharth

siddharth.zarabi@businesstoday.in

@sazarabi

Business Today

<http://www.businesstoday.in>

Chairman & Editor-in-Chief: Aroon Purie
Vice Chairperson & Executive Editor-in-Chief: Kalli Purie
Group Chief Executive Officer: Dinesh Bhatia
Chief Operating Officer: Alok Nair
Group Editor: Siddharth Zarabi
Chief AI Officer, Group Creative Editor: Nilanjan Das
Group Photo Editor: Bhandeep Singh
Executive Editor: Krishna Gopalan
Editor (Special Projects): Tina Edwin

Deputy Editor: Anilkumar Narayan
Economy Editor: Surabhi
Senior Editor: Neetu Chandra Sharma
Associate Editor (Banking): Nachiket Kelkar
Associate Editors: Chetan Bhutani, Karan Dhar
Senior Assistant Editors: Palak Agarwal, Richa Sharma
Special Correspondent: Karishma Asoodani
Principal Correspondent: Aishwarya Patil

COPY DESK

Senior Editor: Mahesh Jagota
Assistant Editors: Bitasta Basu, Kamalika Ghosh

RESEARCH

Chief of Research Bureau: Jyotindra Dubey
Deputy Research Analyst: Prince Tyagi
Research Analyst: Ujjwal Thakur

PHOTOGRAPHY

Senior Photographer: Hardik Chhabra
Photo Coordinator: Vidushi Mehrotra

ART

Art Director: Rahul Sharma
Associate Art Directors: Rajesh Kumar Angira, Raj Verma
Senior Designer: Uma Shankar

PRODUCTION

Chief of Production: Harish Aggarwal
Deputy Manager: Narendra Singh
Production Coordinator: Ayekpam David Meitei

LIBRARY

Librarian: Satbir Singh

Executive Secretary: Jyoti Kochhar

BUSINESS TEAM

Publisher: Siddhartha Chatterjee
General Manager & North Head: Ateet Dhandu
Assistant General Manager (Mumbai): Rohit Subramanian
Assistant General Manager (Chennai): P. Varunam
Assistant General Manager (Govt Sales): Manoj Gotherwal
Chief Manager: Sourabh Dutta

AD OPS

Deputy General Manager: Avinash Karkera
Marketing: Vivek Malhotra, Group Chief Marketing Officer
Newsstand Sales: Deepak Bhatt,
 Assistant Vice President – Sales and Distribution;
 Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North);
 Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West);
 Manan Hossain, Regional Sales Manager (East)



Vol. 35, No. 17, for the fortnight August 3, 2026, to August 16, 2026. Released on August 3, 2026.

● Editorial Office: India Today Mediaplex, FC 8, Sector 16/A, Film City, Noida-201301; Tel: 0120-4807100; Fax: 0120-4807150 ● Advertising Office (Gurgaon): A1-A2, Enkay Centre, Ground Floor, V.N. Commercial Complex, Udyog Vihar, Phase 5, Gurgaon-122001; Tel: 0124-4948400; Fax: 0124-4030919; Mumbai: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One World Centre (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Tel: 022-69193355; Fax: 022-66063226; Chennai: 5th Floor, Main Building No. 443, Guna Complex, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai-600018; Tel: 044-28478525; Fax: 044-24361942; Bangalore: 202-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Tel: 080-22212448, 080-30374106; Fax: 080-22218335; Kolkata: 52, J.L. Road, 4th floor, Kolkata-700071; Tel: 033-22825398, 033-22827726; 033-22821922; Fax: 033-22827254; Hyderabad: 6-3-885/7/8, Raj Bhawan Road, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Tel: 040-23401657, 040-23400479; Ahmedabad: 2nd Floor, 2C, Surya Rath Building, Behind White House, Panchwati, Off. C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Tel: 079-6560393, 079-6560929; Fax: 079-6565293; Kochi: Karaklatt Road, Kochi-682016; Tel: 0484-2377057, 0484-2377058; Fax: 0484-370962 ● Subscriptions: For assistance contact Customer Care India Today Group, C-9, Sector-10, Noida (UP) - 201301.

Email: we care@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Friday, 10 am-6 pm)

● Sales: General Manager Sales, Living Media India Ltd, C-9, Sector 10, Noida (U.P.) - 201301; Tel: 0120-4019500; Fax: 0120-4019664 © 1998 Living Media India Ltd.

All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.

● Printed & published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Private Limited, 18-35, Milestone, Delhi-Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007 (Haryana), Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. Editor: Siddharth Zarabi

● Business Today does not take responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only.



For reprint rights and syndication enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000

www.syndicationstoday.in